

FEATURE ROADMAP

Feature name: Canvas Quick-Start Guide (PRD v2)

Team: Lebert McDonald, Jason Zeng, Abdoul, Mofazzal Hossain

Client: Head of Product

Date: September 15, 2026

1. MILESTONES

Day 15 (Wed, 9/16) — Owner: Lebert McDonald — Status: Not started

What has to be true: The eligibility check works on its own. The system can correctly tell the difference between a genuinely new browser and one with existing drawings, saved library items, or a "seen the guide" flag, and shows a rough, non-interactive prompt only in the new case. No hints yet, no behavior tracking. Just proving the gate works.

Exit check (P0): A user can begin drawing immediately, without ever touching the prompt at all, even with the placeholder prompt on screen.

Day 16 (Sat, 9/19) — Owner: Jason Zeng — Status: Not started

What has to be true: One real hint responds to one real user action. A user who opts in sees the first hint (for example, the shape-tool highlight), and if they create a shape themselves, the hint disappears on its own. The explicit "end the guide" control is real and working, not a placeholder.

Exit check (P0, re-verified): Confirm the added interactivity hasn't introduced any delay or side effect for a user who never touches the prompt at all.

Day 17 (Sun, 9/20) — Owner: Abdoul — Status: Not started

What has to be true: Buffer and hardening day. Fix whatever broke or ran long from Day 16 before adding new behavior. If Day 16 landed clean, use this day to start the next hint in the chain (labeling) rather than letting it slip into Day 18.

Day 18 (Mon, 9/21) — Owner: Mofazzal Hossain — Status: Not started

What has to be true: The full behavior chain works end to end for the primary use case, including the P0 edge cases. A user can go from blank canvas, through opting in, through all four behavior-based hints (shape tool, labeling, connecting, finished/save), with each one disappearing once completed rather than repeating. The system correctly distinguishes user-authored actions from system-inserted starter content, imports, and remote collaborator edits. Save-state confirmation is real, and an untouched starter's automatic save does not count as a genuine save.

Day 19 (Tue, 9/22) — Owner: Lebert McDonald — Status: Not started

What has to be true: Buffer and polish day. Visual rough edges get cleaned up, and any P0 requirement that's still shaky from Day 18 gets fixed here rather than carried into the final day.

Day 20 (Wed, 9/23) — Owner: Jason Zeng — Status: Not started

What has to be true: The feature is demo-ready and provably working, not just working when we personally test it. Analytics events (eligibility, exposure, opt-in, first user-authored action, save outcome) are recording accurately and identically for control and treatment groups. P1/P2 items are confirmed cut if anything is still at risk, so the P0 loop stays protected.

Exit check (P0): Confirm analytics collection excludes drawing text, images, and full scene contents, only the defined event metadata is captured, for both control and treatment groups.

2. RISKS & DEPENDENCIES

- **RESOLVED** (spike completed prior to build start): We previously flagged uncertainty over whether Excalidraw's local storage and library data was structured in a checkable way. The spike confirmed it is: we identified the existing `STORAGE_KEYS` pattern, the `WelcomeScreen.Hints` arrow components, and the `elements.length`-driven toggle that already detects whether a user has drawn something. Day 15's eligibility check builds directly on these three pieces rather than starting from an unknown.
- **Dependency**: Need the Head of Product to confirm which of the three session-reset interpretations (user-level first-session activation, attempt-level completion, or later activation) is the official reporting metric, before we lock in what "success" means for the analytics work in Day 18-20.
- **Dependency**: Need confirmation on what exact threshold counts as "complete and save a first drawing," and which surface (free editor local storage vs. Plus cloud) counts, before the save-state work on Day 18 can be considered finished rather than a guess.
- **Risk**: We don't yet know what percentage of new signups actually fail at the step this feature targets. Without that baseline, we can build the whole feature correctly and still not know if it's solving a real problem at real scale.

3. WHAT WE'RE CUTTING FIRST IF WE RUN OUT OF TIME

- **First to cut**: Collaborator-specific handling (User Journey 2). The PRD already scopes this as a separate, later initiative, not core to this MVP.
- **Second to cut**: Manually reopening guidance later from a help menu (P2). Nice to have, not load-bearing for the core hypothesis.
- **Third to cut**: Dismissing an individual hint without dismissing the whole guide (P1). If time is tight, the all-or-nothing "end the guide" control from Day 16 still satisfies the non-negotiable P0 requirement on its own.